

Ἕννυμος Κουρητῶν ὕμνος

The Hymn of the Curetes and Cretan Ritual Song

eul_aid: aku

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)

Dialect: Δωρική [Doric](#)

Domain: Ποίησις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

The Hymn of the Curetes is an anonymous Archaic cult song, traditionally dated to the 7th century BCE. It is associated with the mythical Curetes, youthful deities connected to the protection of the infant Zeus on Crete and to initiatory rites. The hymn's Doric dialect suggests an origin or primary use in the Peloponnese or Crete, where cults of the Curetes were prominent.

The single known work is the Hymn of the Curetes. This fragmentary cult hymn survives primarily through a quotation in Strabo's *Geographica*, where it is cited as an example of hymns from the Samothracian mysteries. The fragment describes the Curetes as armed dancers whose drumming drowned out the cries of the infant Zeus.

The hymn is a significant artifact of early Greek religious poetry, providing direct evidence for the performance and content of Archaic cult hymns connected to mystery rites. Its preservation by Strabo illustrates the syncretic nature of Hellenistic religion, showing its use in the Samothracian mysteries, which conflated the Curetes with the Corybantes. It is a key source for understanding the link between divine mythology and ritual practice.

Works (1)

- Ἕννυμος Κουρητῶν · [Hymn of the Curetes](#) · 63 passages